



MAKERERE UNIVERSITY



MAKERERE UNIVERSITY ACADEMIC RECORDS MANAGEMENT POLICY

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ACRONYMS AND DEFINITION OF KEY TERMS

DARP: Digitalizing Academic Records and Processes

MAK: Makerere University Kampala

Term	Definition
"Accurate Record"	This is a record that accurately reflects the business transactions of what it document.
"Authentic Record"	A record that can be proved to be what it purports to be. It is also a record that is considered by the creators to be their official record because it accurately reflects the business activities of the organization or institution and how they took place.
"Authoritative Record"	This is a record that is authentic, reliable, useable, complete and unaltered.
"Complete Record"	This is a record that is sufficient in content, context and structure to reconstruct the relevant activities and transactions that took place.
"Destruction"	The action of eliminating or removal of academic records or documents from the record keeping system through deletion, formatting of media, shredding, burning or pulping.
"Departmental Archive"	The place designated for storage and preservation of academic records under the Department of the Academic Registrar. This is on level 1, Senate building.
"Disposal"	Actions taken to dispose of academic records or documents after expiry of the retention period. The action can lead to either archiving or destruction
"Document"	A structured unit of information regardless of format or medium that is managed as a discreet unit or object. Some documents are academic records because they are by-products of business transactions that have been captured as evidence of those transactions. Conversely, not all documents are academic records simply because they do not serve as evidence of business transactions.
"Electronic Record"	Also sometimes referred to as "digital record". This is information which is generated electronically that requires a combination of computer hardware and software to be read and understood.

Term	Definition
"File Plan"	A predetermined classification plan by which academic records are filed manually and electronically and indexed to facilitate efficient retrieval and disposal.
"ICT"	Information and Communication Technology: the diverse set of technological tools and resources used to transmit, store, create, share or exchange information
"Metadata"	Data describing the context, content and structure of academic records and their management through time. Academic records metadata is thus structured or semi-structured information that describes or explains the creation, registration, classification, maintenance, access, use and disposal of academic records through time and across domains. Metadata is critical to record keeping as it is used to identify, authenticate and contextualize academic records and the people, processes and systems that create, manage, maintain and use academic records and the policies that govern them.
"Record"	A record is information in any medium, created, received and maintained as evidence and information by an organization or person, in pursuance of legal obligations or in the transaction of business.
"Record keeping"	The process of making and maintaining complete, accurate and reliable evidence of official business in the form of recorded information.
"Academic records Management"	The process of ensuring the proper creation, maintenance, use and disposal of academic records throughout their life cycle to achieve efficiency, transparency and accountability
"Scheduling"	The process of disposing of academic records in accordance with the retention period prescribed in the retention/disposal schedule.
"University Record"	A record, regardless of format or medium, created or received by Makerere University in pursuance of its activities.
"Mak"	Makerere University

CHARACTERISTICS OF A RECORD

Authenticity

An authentic record is one that is proven both to be what it purports to be and to have been created or sent by the person who purports to have created it. Authentic academic records are a product of organization policies and procedures that control the creation, transmission and maintenance of academic records, ensuring that academic records creators are authorized and identified and that academic records are protected against unauthorized addition, deletion and alteration.

Reliability

A reliable record is one whose contents can be trusted as a full and accurate representation of the transactions, activities or facts to which it attests and can be depended upon in the course of subsequent transactions or activities.

Integrity

The integrity of a record is found in its being complete and unaltered.

Usability

A usable record is one which can be located, retrieved, presented and interpreted. It should be capable of being connected to the business transaction that created it.

Accuracy, Adequacy and Completeness

A record should correctly reflect what was communicated, decided or done and should provide the evidence needed for accountability purposes. The structure, content and context of the record should therefore be preserved.

1.0 INTRODUCTION AND BACKGROUND

1.1 Introduction

- a. The Academic Records Management Policy regulates processing and management of students' records through their stay at the University. The Policy cover includes:
 - 1. Application forms for enrolment
 - 2. Admission lists
 - 3. Admission letters
 - 4. Registration forms
 - 5. Examination results
 - 6. Progression reports
 - 7. Graduation awards (transcripts and certificates)
 - 8. Agenda records for academic meetings
- b. The policy regulates the academic records within the Academic Registrar's Department, the Colleges and other academic units. The focus of the Policy is on creation, storage, retention, retrieval and disposal of academic records.

1.2 Purpose of the Academic Records Management Policy

- a. This policy has been developed with reference to the National Records and Archives Act, 2001 and the International Records Management Standard ISO 15489.
- b. The purpose of this Policy is to provide a framework for the management of academic records in Makerere University (Mak) and to ensure that all activities and decisions of the University are fully and accurately documented and managed in accordance with the life cycle principles of records creation, maintenance, use and disposal.
- c. This policy aims to promote the accessibility and sharing of information within the University and to enhance performance of business activities and service

delivery. The policy will also contribute towards compliance with the University's obligation for transparency and accountability to its clients and other stakeholders.

- d. This policy limits itself to Makerere University academic records.

1.3 Policy Context and Rationale

- a. This policy is linked to and provides the policy framework for the management of academic records within the context of Makerere University programmes and initiatives.
- b. Records management is fundamental for good governance, effective and efficient administration. Records management forms the basis for formulating policy, managing resources and delivering services to the public.
- c. Makerere University recognizes that creation and maintenance of authentic, reliable and useable academic records is paramount to support continued service delivery and provide the necessary accountability
- d. The principle of academic records management is to ensure that a record is managed through its full records life cycle i.e. the creation or receipt of a record, maintenance of the record, managing its use, access to it, storage, retrieval and finally disposal of the record.

Makerere University undertakes to ensure that the integrity of the academic records is protected for as long as they are required as evidence of business operations.

- e. Good management of academic records and the information contained therein will improve service delivery in Mak by:
 - 1. Efficient location, access and retrieval of Academic records.
 - 2. Better protection and secure storage of Information.
 - 3. Safe and timely disposal of Academic records.

1.4 Overall Policy Objectives

The main objective of the Academic Records Management Policy is to provide a framework that will result in the production of academic records which have authenticity, reliability, integrity, usability, accuracy, adequacy and completeness.

The objectives of this policy are:

- a. To establish a uniform academic records management programme for Makerere University which is coordinated with policies, procedures and systems for the purpose of managing academic records.
- b. To adopt sound records management practices as a basic requirement of the University's business activities and processes.
- c. To ensure that the existing records management practices comply with the legal, regulatory and statutory requirements of the Government of Uganda.
- d. To secure and protect all academic records of the University in a manner commensurate to their value and use.
- e. To create, process, maintain use and dispose of all academic records, regardless of the format or medium, in a professional manner and to promote efficiency and effectiveness in service delivery.

1.5 Policy Benefits

This policy will provide the following benefits to Makerere University:

- a. Improve efficiency and productivity through the conduct of the University's academic business in an orderly, efficient and accountable manner.
- b. Reduce operating costs through the efficient and effective management of space, equipment, technology and through the application of academic records retention/disposal schedules.
- c. Ensure regulatory compliance with the provisions of legislative and regulatory frameworks governing records and archives management in Uganda as well as those regulating Makerere University.

- d. Foster professionalism in running the University through improved arrangement and storage of academic records, improved turn-around-times and protection of confidential official information.
- e. Assimilate new records management technologies to leverage efficiency, economy and effectiveness and to foster e-service delivery.
- f. Support improved decision making by ensuring that all decision makers at various levels have timely access to any relevant information.
- g. Provide protection and support to the University through the management of risks associated with the existence or lack of evidence during litigation involving the University.
- h. Protect the interests of the University and the rights of employees, clients (students) and any other stakeholders.
- i. Preserve the University's memory through documenting and preserving academic records and information of historical value to the University.
- j. Safeguard vital information which is critical for business resumption/continuity in the event of a disaster.

1.6 Scope

This policy applies to all academic records in the University concerning students regardless of media or format created or received. The policy provides for the following:

- a. The requirements that academic records must comply with to be considered as proper academic records of the business activities they represent.
- b. The scope of systems and processes required to ensure the capture, integrity, security, irretrievability and usability of academic records.
- c. Staff responsibilities for management of academic records.
- d. Provision for regular review of the policy.

1.7 Overall Responsibility

The overall coordination and implementation of this policy shall be with the Academic Registrar, who shall be responsible for:

- a. Designing and Implementing an academic records Management Programme that supports compliance with this Policy;
- b. Maintenance of the Academic Records Classification Scheme;
- c. Overseeing and implementing the academic records retention and disposal schedules and for transferring non-current academic records to the Archives;
- d. Ensuring that all staff including volunteers and contractors are aware of and have access to the Academic Records Management Policy, procedures, standards and guidelines;
- e. Ensuring staff working for the University have adequate support in their efforts to comply with the Academic Records Management Policy;
- f. Ensuring appropriate resources (time, systems and staff) are allocated to oversee the implementation of the Academic Records Management Policy;
- g. Maintaining and reviewing the Academic Records Management Policy.

1.7.1 Responsibility and Accountability of Individuals

- a. Academic records management is the responsibility of every staff in the University. Every member of staff is responsible for maintaining adequate and complete academic records as may be necessary to document the full business functions, activities, transactions, decisions and operations of the Department.
- b. All staff will be accountable for the academic records which they create, use, manage or records under their control or custody.
- c. All University employees leaving service shall surrender all or any University record within their custody to their immediate supervisors.
- d.

1.7.2 The Departmental Archive

- a. The Departmental Archive has the responsibility to preserve the archives that have been transferred to its custody and to be involved with the management of current academic records including the electronic academic records management systems. The Departmental Archivist shall be in charge of the archives.
- b. Control of the destruction and disposal of University academic records is the responsibility of the Deputy Vice-Chancellor (Academic Affairs) and no official academic records may be disposed of without the written authority of the Vice-Chancellor. Retention and Disposal Schedules of Academic Records shall be approved by the Deputy Vice-Chancellor (Academic affairs).

2. POLICY STATEMENTS

2.1 Creation, Record and Receipt of academic records

- a. Academic records created or received in the course of the University's business shall be the property of the University and shall be captured into the record keeping system.
- b. When creating academic records, staff shall ensure that they create academic records that are complete, accurate and contain sufficient information and details to enable them to provide authoritative and authentic evidence of the transactions that they represent.
- c. Once captured into the record keeping system, academic records may not be altered.
- d. The formats used when creating academic records must be those that promote long-term preservation, retrieval and usability of the academic records.

2.2 Registration, Classification and Indexing

- a. Academic records shall be classified as per Makerere University Academic Records Classification Scheme to enhance storage and retrieval.
- b. The academic records shall be indexed so as to provide adequate data to facilitate linking, search, retrieval and disposal.

- c. Document naming conventions shall be used for electronic academic records as per the procedures prescribed from time to time.
- d. Metadata, i.e. data that provides information about the record, shall also be recorded as per the prescribed procedures.

2.3 Storage and Maintenance

- a. Academic records shall be managed through a life cycle; i.e. from the time the academic records are created to the time of their disposal.
- b. There shall be appropriate storage, preservation and protection of academic records.
- c. The Academic Registrar's Department shall ensure adequate storage space, supplies, equipment and other resources necessary for the safekeeping of academic records.

2.4 Access, Use and Tracking of academic records

- a. Academic records shall be accessible and promptly availed for use.
- b. Controls to regulate access to academic records and data, movement of academic records, tracking and recording is detailed in the procedures and guidelines attached to this policy in Part 2.

2.5 Retention and Disposal

- a. Disposal of academic records that are no longer required for operational purposes shall be done in a timely manner according to the retention and disposal schedule developed by the Academic Registrar's Departmental Management Committee and approved by the Academic Records Management Committee may determine.
- b. Academic records of enduring or durable value shall be preserved.
- c. The following academic records shall be kept partly in digital/electronic form and partly in the manual form; and archived by having a copy in the central repository and at the relevant College:

- 1. Admission letter
- 2. Registration forms

3. Academic progress reports
 4. Awards (transcript and certificates)
 5. Examination results
 6. And any other record that may be designated under this category.
- d. There shall be an Academic Records Management Committee which shall be a Sub-Committee of the Academic Policies and Appeals Committee of Senate.
- e. The above-mentioned Committee shall meet at regular intervals. The Committee shall in consultation with the Deputy Vice- Chancellor (Academic Affairs) appraise academic records in line with established academic records appraisal procedures and shall create academic records retention/disposal schedules based on regulatory and legislative requirements.
- f. The Membership of the Academic Records Management Committee shall comprise of:
1. The Academic Registrar (Chairperson)
 2. The Archivist in the Department of the Academic Registrar (Departmental Archivist)
 3. One representative from each College appointed by the Principal of the College.
- g. Academic records with archival value shall be transferred to the custody of the **Departmental Archive** where they will be made available for consultation/access.
- h. Archival academic records transferred to the **Departmental Archive** shall be maintained in accordance with the principles of provenance and original order.

2.6 Acquisition and preservation of Archives

- a. Academic records of national importance shall be acquired and preserved.
- b. The archives shall be catalogued and made available for consultation.
- c. The **Departmental Archive** shall acquire archives, process, preserve and make them available for consultation.

- d. The Departmental Archivist shall ensure that the archives are protected and secured against any potential hazards or threats capable of damaging, manipulating or altering their structure or contents, and that such preservation shall safeguard the integrity of the archives.
- e. Adequate technologies shall be deployed for preservation of digital academic records across versions of technology to ensure long-term accessibility and availability.

2.7 Legislative and Regulatory Framework

The University shall ensure that academic records are managed in accordance with this policy and any other relevant legislative and regulatory instruments promulgated by the Government of Uganda.

The said relevant laws and regulations include the following:

1. National Academic Records and Archives Act, 2001
2. Access to Information Act, 2005
3. Electronic Transactions Act, 2011
4. Computer Misuse Act, 2011
5. Copyright and Neighbouring Rights Act, 2006
6. The Universities and Other Tertiary Institutions (Management of Constituent Colleges of Makerere University) Statute, 2012
7. Universities and Other Tertiary Institutions Act, 2001 (as amended)

2.8 Academic records Management Infrastructure

The University shall provide records management infrastructure including rules and regulations, standards and procedures, systems, technologies and skilled human capital to support and facilitate academic records management.

2.9 Use of International Standards and Best Practices

- a. The University shall encourage the adoption and use of international records management standards and best practice.

- b. The academic records management functionality shall be embedded into ICT systems developed or acquired for use by the University.

2.10 Staff Capacity and Training

- a. The University shall periodically conduct training needs assessments for academic records/archives management and shall provide training and capacity building for staff and other users as and when it is deemed necessary.
- b. Schemes of service shall be developed and implemented for the academic records and archives management cadres.

2.11 Monitoring and Review

- a. The Director Internal Audit shall conduct a monitoring and Compliance monitoring audit on the academic records management systems in the University.
- b. The Directorate for ICT (DICTS) shall regularly evaluate efficiency and effectiveness of the Academic Records Management Systems
- c. This Policy may be reviewed to take into account technological and any other deserving developments.

3.0 GUIDELINES AND PROCEDURES FOR CREATION, RETENTION AND DISPOSAL OF ACADEMIC RECORDS

3.1 Creation, Capture and Receipt of academic records

- a. Academic records created in the normal course of business by any member of staff shall be the property of the University and shall be captured into a record keeping system.
- b. Once captured into the record keeping system, academic records shall not be altered.
- c. Document naming conventions shall be used for electronic academic records in compliance with the procedures prescribed from time to time.
- d. The formats used when creating academic records must be those that promote long-term preservation, retrieval and usability of the academic records.
- e. When creating academic records, members of staff shall ensure that they create academic records that are complete, accurate and contain sufficient information and details to enable them to provide authoritative and authentic evidence of the transactions that they represent.
- f. Academic creators of records and users of academic records shall be made aware of the distinction between academic records and non-academic records.

3.2 Registration, Classification and Indexing

- a. Unique identifiers shall be used when registering and indexing academic records so as to provide evidence of when the academic records were created and captured into the recordkeeping system and to enable them to be identified and distinguished from other academic records.
- b. The academic records shall be classified and indexed to allow for appropriate linking, grouping, retrieval, usage and disposition.
- c. The University Academic Records Classification Scheme shall be used for the classification of academic records created by the University.
- d. The University Academic Records Classification Scheme shall be based on the classification of the business activities of the University.

- e. The classification of academic records in compliance with the University Academic Records Classification Scheme shall apply to both paper and electronic academic records.
- f. Registration, classification and indexing systems shall be managed and controlled by appropriate officers to ensure their effectiveness, accuracy and sustainability.
- g. All officers that generate, receive and maintain academic records in their offices shall be capacitated to register and classify academic records as per the Classification Scheme of the University.
- h. Metadata, i.e. data that provides information about the record, shall also be recorded in compliance with the prescribed procedures.

3.3 Storage and Maintenance

- a. Records storage arrangements shall take into consideration the format, media, nature and use of the academic records as well as migration requirements in the case of electronic records.
- b. Current records which are active and still being used and referred to regularly shall be filed and stored in copy in the Central registry, operational offices at the Colleges and within the Electronic Record keeping System.
- c. Semi-current academic records which are referred to less frequently but still needed for the execution of current business shall be transferred to the Departmental records Centre or held in the Electronic Record keeping System.

3.4 Access, Use and Tracking of academic records

- a. Procedures for access and use of academic records shall be developed and enforced; and shall define access and authority controls stipulating which officer can have access to what academic records and which access rights shall be enforced within the record keeping system.
- b. To facilitate granting of access rights, academic records shall be categorized according to their level of sensitivity and or confidentially. Academic records

that are restricted shall be boldly stamped or watermarked to reflect their access status.

- c. The Electronic Record keeping System shall be the primary vehicle for the movement and tracking of electronic academic records in the University.
- d. Other instruments, manual and electronic shall be developed and used for the tracking of paper academic records.
- e. Electronic record keeping systems shall provide for audit trails and event logs to record all actions applied on an e-record within the system, the time, dates and persons responsible for the actions.
- f. Public access to academic records shall be regulated by the legislative regulations relating to access and provision of information to the public.
- g. Authority to access the University academic records by the public shall be granted by the Vice Chancellor.

3.5 Appraisal, Retention and Disposal

- a. The appraisal of academic records, retention and disposal schedules shall be at the level of academic records series and sub-series level.
- b. Academic units shall apply for the retention and disposal of common classes of academic records.
- c. Academic units shall apply to the Academic Records Management Committee for approval of disposal of documents whose value has expired.
- d. For the avoidance of doubt, no academic records may be destroyed without the final approval of the Vice-Chancellor after a recommendation by the Academic Records Management Committee.
- e. The disposal and destruction of Academic records shall follow the Academic records retention and disposal schedules.
- f. A designated University official shall be present during the destruction or disposal process to ensure that the academic records are thoroughly destroyed.

- g. The Methods of disposal and destruction of academic records shall be as is appropriate to the type of record and medium and shall preserve the confidentiality of any information they contain.
- h. All academic records with archival value shall be transferred to the custody of the **Departmental Archives** where they will be made available for consultation.
- i. Archival records transferred to the **Departmental Archives** shall be maintained in accordance with the principles of provenance and original order.
- j. The Academic Records Management Committee, shall:
 - 1. Appraise academic records in compliance with established academic records appraisal procedures.
 - 2. Create academic records retention and disposal schedules based on regulatory and legislative requirements.
 - 3. Issue records retention and disposal schedules for common categories of academic records.
 - 4. Receive application for disposal of academic records from the different divisions of the Academic Registrar's Department and Colleges.
 - 5. Approve disposal of academic records of short term value as soon as the retention materials mature as soon as units notify the Committee.
 - 6. Recommend to the Deputy Vice-Chancellor (Academic Affairs) destruction and disposal of academic records which are of no value and those whose retention period has expired.

3.6 Acquisition and preservation of Archives

- a. The **Archivist** shall acquire archives, process, preserve and make them available for consultation.
- b. The **Departmental Archivist** shall ensure that the archives are protected and secured against any potential hazards, risks or threats capable of damaging, manipulating or altering their structure or contents, and that such preservation shall safeguard the integrity of the archives.

- c. Adequate technologies shall be deployed for preservation of digital academic records across versions of technology to ensure long-term accessibility and availability.

3.7 Legislative and Regulatory Framework

- a. Officers in the University shall manage their academic records according to all applicable legislative and regulatory instruments and policies.
- b. The Academic Registrar's Office shall ensure that staff are familiar with the statutory, regulatory and policy instruments that are relevant to the management of academic records generated or received by the University.
- c. The development of any policies and other regulations relating to academic records shall involve consultations with all stakeholders.

3.8 Academic records Management Infrastructure

- a. The University shall appropriate resources to the academic records management function to enable continuous improvement of the University academic records management infrastructure.
- b. The Academic Records Management Committee shall develop implementation plans for the Academic Records Management Policy.

3.9 Staff Capacity and Training

Training of members of staff and other users shall be done by the Academic Registrar's Department to improve academic records management practices and capacity building of staff involved in academic records management.

3.10 Monitoring and Review

The Director Internal Auditor shall provide periodic and consistent monitoring, auditing and review of this policy. The following shall be done in the conduct of the audit:

- 1. Monitoring for compliance shall be conducted on the academic records management systems by the Directorate of Internal Auditor to ensure that the

academic records management systems and procedures are being implemented and adhered to.

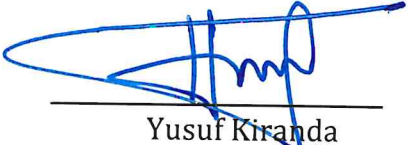
Regular evaluations shall be conducted to ensure efficiency and effectiveness of the academic records management systems.

3.11 Approval and Implementation

The Policy shall take effect upon approval and promulgation by the Makerere University Council.

DATED this 5TH day of SEPTEMBER 2024

Lorna Magara (Mrs.)
CHAIRPERSON OF COUNCIL



Yusuf Kiranda
SECRETARY OF COUNCIL